

Lesson 4: Past Continuous (I was doing) for IT Professionals

Understanding Past Continuous in IT Context

"Hello, welcome to our lesson today. We will learn about the past continuous tense, like 'I was doing,' and its use in IT. This tense is important for talking about actions that were in progress at a certain time in the past. For example, if you were working on a coding task yesterday at 3 PM, you say, 'I was coding yesterday at 3 PM.' This shows the action was happening at that specific time but is not happening now.

In IT, we often need to describe what we were doing at a particular time, especially when troubleshooting or explaining a process. How do you talk about these actions? You probably use past continuous. For instance, 'I was analyzing the data when the system crashed.' It helps describe ongoing actions in the past."

Describing Problem-Solving in Past Continuous

"Let's talk about using past continuous in problem-solving scenarios. In IT, when a problem occurs, we often need to explain what we were doing at that time. How do you describe this? You might use past continuous. For example, 'I was updating the software when the error appeared.' This shows that the error occurred during the process of updating.

Think about a recent issue you encountered in your work. How did you explain what you were doing at that time? You likely used past continuous to make it clear that the action was in progress."

Using Past Continuous in Project Updates

"In project updates, especially for longer tasks, we often use past continuous. How do you describe what you were doing on a project at a specific time? Maybe, you say, 'I was working on the database last night.' This tells your team that you were in the middle of working on the database at that time.

In your project updates, when you talk about ongoing tasks, do you find past continuous useful for showing that these tasks were in progress?"

Past Continuous for Technical Troubleshooting

"In technical troubleshooting, past continuous is very useful. When a problem is reported, we often need to describe what was happening at that time. How do you talk about the system's state during an issue? You might say, 'The server was running slowly when the crash happened.' This provides a clear picture of the system's state at the time of the crash.

When you troubleshoot, do you use past continuous to describe the conditions leading up to an issue?"

Personal Experience in Teaching Past Continuous

"I want to share a story from my teaching. One of my students, an IT professional, asked, 'Why can't we say 'I fixed the bug when the system crashed'? A good question. We use past continuous to emphasize that an action was happening at the same time as another action. So, it's better to say, 'I was fixing the bug when the system crashed.'

Have you ever been confused about when to use past continuous? It's common, but understanding its use is key for clear communication in IT."

Reflecting on Learning Experiences in Past Continuous

"In IT, reflecting on our learning experiences is important. How do you talk about what you were learning at a specific time in the past? You might use past continuous, like 'I was studying JavaScript when I decided to specialize in front-end development.' This shows the learning process was happening at that time.

When you think about your past learning experiences, do you find past continuous helpful for describing ongoing learning processes?"

Engaging with the Audience

"Imagine if you didn't use past continuous to talk about your past actions in IT. How would it affect your explanations? Using past continuous correctly is very important for accurate communication about past ongoing actions.

How often do you use past continuous in your day-to-day work? Quite a lot, right? Especially in situations like troubleshooting or giving detailed project updates."

Using Past Continuous in Collaborative Projects

"In collaborative projects, we often find ourselves in situations where explaining ongoing activities becomes crucial. How do you tell your colleague what you were working on when they were not around? You might use past continuous. For example, 'Yesterday at 10 AM, I was testing the new software module.' This clearly indicates that at that specific time, you were engaged in an action.

Think about a recent collaborative project. How often did you find yourself using past continuous to explain your part of the work? It's quite useful, right? It helps in painting a picture of your work progress at specific times."

Past Continuous in IT Meetings

"During IT meetings, especially when discussing past events, how do you talk about what was happening at a particular time? We often use past continuous in such scenarios. For instance, 'During the network outage last night, I was monitoring the server status.' This sentence tells others that you were actively engaged in a specific task during the event.

In your experience, do you use past continuous in meetings to describe your actions during past events? It makes the timeline of events clearer, doesn't it?"

Technical Documentation and Past Continuous

"When writing technical documentation, particularly about past events or processes, how do you describe ongoing actions? Past continuous is quite handy here. You might write, 'The system was undergoing maintenance when the error was reported.' This gives a clear context of what was happening at that time.

How often do you use past continuous when documenting technical processes? It's an effective way to provide a detailed and accurate description of events as they were unfolding."

Story from Online Teaching

"Let me share a personal teaching experience. A student, working in IT, once asked me, 'Why do we say 'I was reviewing the code when the application crashed' instead of 'I reviewed the code when the application crashed'?' This

question opened a discussion about the importance of context. The past continuous, 'I was reviewing,' implies that the action was in progress at the time of the crash, providing a clearer picture of the situation.

Have you encountered similar situations where choosing the right tense made a big difference in clarity?"

Troubleshooting and Past Continuous

"In troubleshooting, especially when diagnosing issues, how do you describe what you were doing when the problem occurred? Past continuous is essential here. Saying, 'I was running a diagnostic test when the system showed the error message,' helps in understanding the circumstances leading up to the problem.

When you troubleshoot, do you find past continuous helpful for explaining the state of things at the time of the issue?"

Reflecting on Past Training Sessions

"Think about past training sessions or workshops you attended. How do you describe what you were learning at that time? Using past continuous, like 'I was learning about cloud computing when I decided to focus on this area,' shows that the learning was an ongoing process at that specific time.

Do you often reflect on your learning experiences using past continuous? It's a great way to describe the journey of your professional development."

Engaging with the Audience

"How would your explanations of past IT situations change if you didn't use past continuous? Can you see how it might affect the clarity of your communication? Proper use of past continuous is crucial for accurately describing ongoing actions in the past.

In your daily IT work, how frequently do you find yourself using past continuous? It's probably quite often, especially when giving detailed descriptions of past events or actions."

Past Continuous for Effective Communication

"In effective communication within the IT field, especially when dealing with past events or actions, how important do you think is the role of past continuous? It allows us to set the scene and provide a background of ongoing activities, doesn't it?"

"Think about a recent incident where using past continuous helped you in effectively communicating the situation. How did it impact the understanding of the event?"